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E2. Levels of Study

As noted earlier, the French higher education system follows the LMD system (*Licence-Master-Doctorat*, or bachelor-master-doctoral).

Sub-degree qualifications are also available, notably the *Diplômes universitaires uechnologiques* (DUT). This nationally accredited diploma is awarded for students completing two years of post-secondary study, after which the student may enter the work force, continue to study for an additional year to earn a *Licence pro* degree (see below) or continue on to other university studies.



Bachelor's level

There are two types of bachelor's degrees in France: the *Licence professionnelle* (more commonly referred to as the *Licence pro*) and the *Licence*. The first is a professional or vocational bachelor's and the second is a traditional bachelor's degree. These are completed in three years and degrees are awarded once 180 ECTS (under the European Credit Transfer System) have been obtained.

***Licence pro* (three years)**

Students enjoy the experience of an education delivered in close collaboration between universities and industry with a good deal of instruction provided by outside professionals. An internship is typically part of the experience. There are many fields of study offered at the *Licence pro* level including tourism and hospitality, agricultural and industrial production, health, environmental studies and art and design. Students must have completed two years of university study to be admitted to a *Licence pro* programme and then they study for one year in their chosen field to obtain their degree.

Campus France notes that "graduates of some professional *Licence pro* programmes are eligible to enroll directly in 1- or 2-year professional master's programmes." Apprenticeships are readily available to complement vocational training degrees and they span more than 450 trades.

For more information on the *Licence pro*, please consult [this Campus France brief](#).

***Licence* (three years)**

This degree is a traditional bachelor's degree with four study area options (known as *mentions*):

1. Arts, languages and literature;
2. Human and social sciences;
3. Law, economics and management;
4. Science, technology and health.

There are also two other degrees at the bachelor's level: the DNA (*Diplôme national d'art, which is an arts degree*) and DEEA (*Diplôme d'études en*

architecture, an architecture degree). These, like the *Licence* and *Licence pro*, are worth 180 ECT credits.

Master's level (two years)

After they complete a *licence* students may apply to a master's programme which they complete in two years (for a total of five years of post-secondary schooling including the three years devoted to the *licence* prior to the master's level). The master's degree is complete once 120 ECTS have been obtained, (300 in total with the *Licence* ECTS added in). There are vocational master's programmes that prepare students to enter the workforce as well as academic ones that can lead to doctoral studies.

Doctorate level

Students may apply for a doctorate degree after having obtained a master's degree. The doctorate involves six semesters divided into teaching and training components and students must complete a thesis that typically takes students three to four years to write. In the end, including the *Licence* and master's degrees required to get into the doctorate, the doctorate is worth 480 ECTS credits and takes eight years to obtain.

Most doctorate programmes are delivered at doctoral institutions in France rather than through general universities.

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